

NewBus Logo Concepts

Five routes to a mark for an intercity bus booking platform — each one grounded in what seven competitors already do, and each shown at the sizes it actually has to survive.

5 CONCEPTS

7 COMPETITORS STUDIED

ICON & LOCKUP · LIGHT & DARK

STATUS: AWAITING SELECTION

THE FIVE MARKS

At a glance

Full specimens, rationale and scale tests for each are further down. The recommendation is **01 Route N**.



01

Route N

The N as a journey between two terminals.



02

Milestone

The Indian highway marker stone.



03

Ticket Notch

Boarding-pass perforation and a chevron.



04

Journey Arc



05

Front Elevation

Origin, destination, one arc.

A bus head-on, not side-on. The control case.

LOCKUP · LIGHT



LOCKUP · DARK



THE BAR

What the mark has to do

Every concept below is judged against these seven criteria. Where a concept is weak on one, it says so rather than hiding it.

Easy to remember

Professional

Modern

Trustworthy

Scalable

Different from competitors

Serious business

STEP ONE

Competitor research

Five Indian intercity players plus two global benchmarks. The point is not to copy any of them — it is to find the space none of them occupies.

BRAND	LOGO STYLE	PALETTE	WEBSITE DESIGN
redBus Market leader	Literal red bus silhouette + lowercase wordmark	 Red + white hex approximate	Dense, promo-heavy; hero search widget above the fold

BRAND	LOGO STYLE	PALETTE	WEBSITE DESIGN
AbhiBus ixigo	Plain modern wordmark, no symbol	 #C22126  #551615 UI adds blue + orange	Multi-vertical tabs, rotating promo banners, SRTC operator grid
zingbus	Minimal modern wordmark	White / blue, green sustainability accents	Clean modular scroll; “your next story is a zingbus away”
IntrCity SmartBus	Wordmark	 Purple	Not assessed — site blocked automated access
Fresh Bus	Contemporary wordmark, tree iconography	 Green primary	Eco/EV framing throughout — Green Coins, CO ₂ metrics
FlixBus Global benchmark	Wordmark with a detachable orange X	 #73D700 + orange	Full-width hero imagery, card modules, repeated app CTA
Busbud Global benchmark	Compact stylised wordmark	 Blue / white, neutral greys	Illustrated hero, trust statistics, generous whitespace

Taken from the live sites where they allowed it. Brandfetch, SchemeColor and redBus all blocked automated access, so redBus’s red is marked approximate rather than stated precisely; AbhiBus and FlixBus hex values come from published sources.

■ What looks good

- **FlixBus’s detachable X.** The best system thinking in the category. The X leaves the wordmark and works alone on a livery, an app icon, a favicon — exactly the icon-only / full-logo split this brief asks for. The lesson is the structure, not the green.
- **Busbud’s restraint.** Whitespace and trust statistics instead of promo clutter. This is what “serious business” looks like on a screen.
- **The hero search widget.** All seven put it above the fold. A solved convention — worth keeping, not worth reinventing.

■ What to avoid

- **Red and orange.** Held by the two largest Indian players. Red is also your interface’s error colour — a red brand fights your own UI every time an alert appears.
- **The side-view bus silhouette.** redBus and most operators use it. It is the category cliché and it collapses into mush at 16px. This is why the current **Lucide** Bus icon has to go.
- **Green.** Fresh Bus and FlixBus use it to claim EV and sustainability credentials. Borrowing it without an electric fleet is a

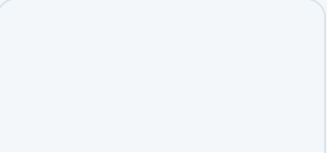
promise you can't keep – a trust risk, and trust is on the brief.

- **Purple** – IntrCity's. And **stock Tailwind blue** `#3b82f6`, currently in your config, which reads to any designer as an untouched default.

STEP TWO

The open territory

Red, orange, green and purple are all claimed. Blue is the strongest trust signal left but generic on its own – so it is anchored deep and paired with a teal nobody in the table owns. Both hold up on the dark mode the product already ships.

			
Midnight Navy <code>#0B1A33</code> Primary. Trust and seriousness, without being a default blue.	Signal Teal <code>#0E9A92</code> Accent. Unclaimed in the category; supplies the modernity.	Teal Bright <code>#2FD3C3</code> Dark-mode accent. Holds contrast on navy grounds.	Cool Paper <code>#F4F7FA</code> Light ground. Biased toward the accent, not a neutral grey.

STEP THREE

Five concepts

Ordered most abstract to most literal, so the trade-off between differentiation and instant recognition is visible. The wordmark is set in Archivo ExtraBold and stays single-colour in all five, so the lockup survives one-colour printing, embroidery, and fax-grade reproduction on an operator's paperwork.

01 Route N

The letter N drawn as a journey: two uprights as terminals, the diagonal between them as the road. The monogram and the route are the same stroke.

LOCKUP · LIGHT



LOCKUP · DARK



ICON ONLY



ICON · REVERSED



SCALE TEST — RENDERED AT REAL PIXEL SIZES



88px



48 · app



32px



24px



16 · favicon

MEMORABLE

A monogram is ownable in a way a generic vehicle never is — it can only mean NewBus.

SCALABLE

Three strokes, one weight, round caps. Still legible at 16px in the strip above.

DIFFERENT

No competitor uses a letterform. It sidesteps both the red palette and the silhouette.

MODERN

The teal diagonal carries the accent, so it reads two-tone when large and holds single-colour when small.

Honest weakness: it does not say “bus” on its own. It needs the wordmark beside it until the brand has recognition — standard for a monogram, but a real cost early on.

02 Milestone

The Indian highway milestone — domed top, painted band, distance below. Intercity road travel stated without drawing a vehicle.

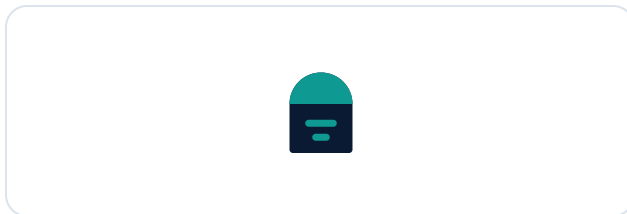
LOCKUP · LIGHT



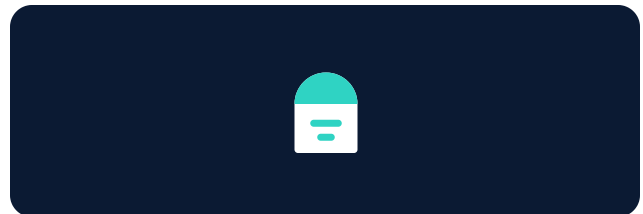
LOCKUP · DARK



ICON ONLY



ICON · REVERSED



SCALE TEST — RENDERED AT REAL PIXEL SIZES



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DIFFERENT

Culturally specific to Indian highways. No competitor in the table can share it, and none does.

TRUSTWORTHY

A milestone is a fixed, official object — it signals infrastructure and permanence, not a startup.

MEMORABLE

A distinctive silhouette, recognisable in outline alone at a distance.

SERIOUS

Reads as a public-works marker rather than a consumer app sticker.

Honest weakness: the two distance bars are the first thing to go below 24px — check the strip. Below that it reduces to a domed shape. Workable, but small sizes need a simplified variant drawn separately.

03 Ticket Notch

The perforation notch of a boarding pass, with a forward chevron inside. It positions NewBus as a *booking* product rather than a bus operator — which is what you actually sell.

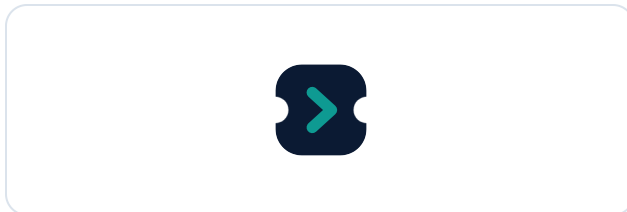
LOCKUP · LIGHT



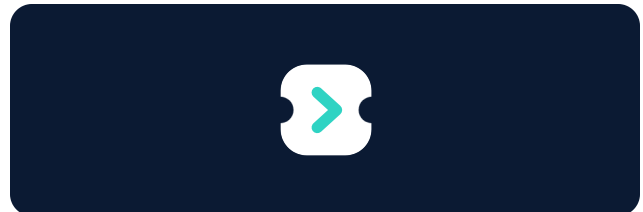
LOCKUP · DARK



ICON ONLY



ICON · REVERSED



SCALE TEST — RENDERED AT REAL PIXEL SIZES



88px



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16 · favicon

STRATEGIC FIT

You are a marketplace, not a fleet. The ticket is the honest object to own — and it stays true if you add trains or flights later.

MODERN

The filled squircle matches how iOS and Android actually mask app icons, so the app icon needs no redraw.

SCALABLE

Solid shape with a high-contrast counter. The strongest performer of the five at 16px.

PROFESSIONAL

Geometric and calm; no illustration to date badly.

Honest weakness: the notched-ticket device is common across travel and events generally. Distinct from the seven studied here, but not unique in the wider world.

04 Journey Arc

Origin, destination, and one arc between them. The smallest possible statement of what the product does.

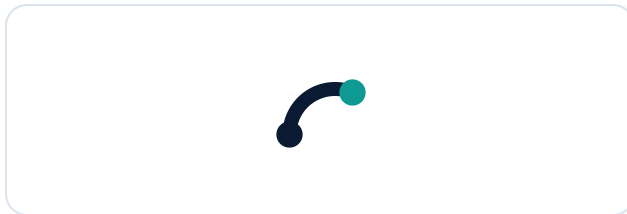
LOCKUP · LIGHT



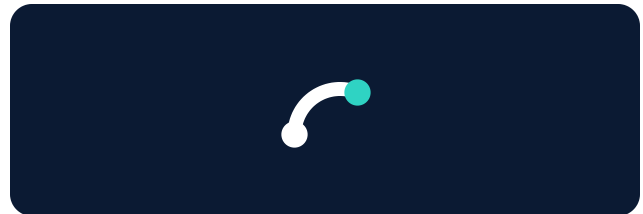
LOCKUP · DARK



ICON ONLY



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SCALE TEST — RENDERED AT REAL PIXEL SIZES



88px



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24px



16 · favicon

PROFESSIONAL

The calmest mark of the five. Closest in feel to Busbud's restraint, which the research flagged as the category's most credible look.

MODERN

The teal destination dot does all the work — a single point of colour, the same discipline FlixBus applies to its X.

SCALABLE

Two dots and a curve. Nothing left to lose at small sizes.

TRUSTWORTHY

Restraint reads as confidence. Nothing here is trying to be liked.

Honest weakness: the weakest on *memorable*. Point-to-point arcs are near-ubiquitous in travel tech, so it risks being handsome and forgettable.

05 Front Elevation

A bus seen head-on rather than side-on, reduced to pure geometry – the control case. Instant category recognition, and the one concept that deliberately breaks the “avoid the silhouette” rule so the abstract four have something to be measured against.

LOCKUP · LIGHT



LOCKUP · DARK



ICON ONLY



ICON · REVERSED



SCALE TEST – RENDERED AT REAL PIXEL SIZES



88px



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32px



24px



16 · favicon

RECOGNISABLE

Nobody has to be told what it is. Zero explanation cost at launch.

PARTLY DIFFERENT

Front-on is the unclaimed angle – every competitor draws the side view. Same subject, different camera.

MODERN

Geometric reduction and a squircle body, rather than the illustrative treatment the

HONEST

Included so the recommendation is a comparison rather than an assertion.

incumbents use.

Honest weakness: it is still a bus, and the brief asks to be different from competitors. The mirrors and headlights also fill in below 24px – visible in the strip. Strongest on recognition, weakest on distinctiveness.

STEP FOUR

Recommendation

Take 01 Route N as the primary, with 03 Ticket Notch as the fallback.

Route N is the only concept that scores on all seven criteria at once. It is ownable, because a monogram can only mean one company. It is different, because no competitor uses a letterform and it avoids both the red palette and the silhouette. And it holds at 16px – which the scale strip demonstrates rather than claims. Its cost is recognition: it needs the wordmark early on.

Ticket Notch is the safer pick if that cost is unacceptable. It is the strongest at small sizes, it matches how app icons are masked so nothing needs redrawing, and it describes your actual business – a marketplace, not a fleet – which keeps it valid if you ever add trains or flights.

I would not recommend **05**, despite it being the easiest to understand. “Different from competitors” is explicitly on the brief, and it is the one concept that concedes that point.

ON YOUR WORD

What happens after you pick

Nothing in the application has changed yet. The header, footer and favicon are still running the stock icon and the leftover scaffolding bolt.

1. Production SVGs for the chosen mark — icon-only and full lockup, light and dark, plus a simplified small-size variant where the scale test showed one is needed.
2. A real `favicon.svg` , replacing the purple lightning bolt the scaffolding tool left behind.
3. `Header.jsx` and `Footer.jsx` moved onto the new lockup — which also fixes the existing inconsistency, where the header gradient runs blue→indigo and the footer blue→rose.
4. `tailwind.config.js` — the `brand` scale retuned from stock Tailwind blue to the navy and teal above.
5. Business card and social avatar artwork, generated from the same source files.